

Restricted Area Access SOP

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1. Purpose

This SOP defines the controls governing access to restricted areas within the facility, including high-voltage substations, server/control rooms, confined spaces, radiation-source areas, and high-security material storage, to prevent unauthorized access and protect both personnel and critical assets.

2. Scope

Applies to all employees, contractors, and visitors, and covers every area designated and signed as 'Restricted Area — Authorized Personnel Only' throughout the site.

3. Classification of Restricted Areas

- High-voltage electrical rooms and substations, restricted due to electrocution and arc-flash risk.
- Confined spaces such as tanks, pits, and vessels, restricted due to atmospheric hazards and engulfment risk.
- Server and control rooms, restricted for both electrical safety and information-security reasons.
- Radiation or NDT (non-destructive testing) source storage, restricted due to radiation exposure risk.
- Chemical and hazardous material storage areas, restricted to trained handling personnel only.

4. Access Control Requirements

Every restricted area is fitted with a physical barrier (locked door, gate, or turnstile) and clear signage stating the specific hazard and authorization requirement. Access is granted only to individuals listed on the area-specific authorized personnel list maintained by the EHS or Security department, and access is logged either electronically (badge/biometric system) or via a manual entry-exit register where electronic systems are not installed.

5. Entry Procedure

- Verify personal authorization for the specific restricted area before approaching the access point.
- Sign the entry-exit register or badge in, recording name, time, purpose, and expected duration of entry.
- Wear all PPE specific to the area's hazard class, as identified on the area's hazard sign, before crossing the barrier.
- For confined space entry, additional permit-to-work and atmospheric testing procedures under the facility's Confined Space Entry program must be completed before this access procedure applies.
- Sign out immediately upon completing the task, and report any observed hazard or anomaly to the area owner before leaving.

6. Escorted Visitor Access

Visitors or contractors requiring access to a restricted area for a specific, approved purpose must be accompanied at all times by an authorized escort who remains responsible for the visitor's safety and compliance with all area-specific requirements. Unescorted visitor access to any restricted area is strictly prohibited.

7. Emergency Access and Override

Emergency responders (fire, medical) are granted immediate access to any restricted area during a declared emergency, with Security providing physical access and briefing on known hazards as quickly as possible without delaying the response. All emergency overrides are logged and reviewed after the event.

8. Monitoring and Audit

Security conducts routine patrols of restricted area perimeters to detect unauthorized access attempts, tailgating, or propped-open barriers. CCTV coverage, where installed, is reviewed periodically. The EHS department conducts a quarterly audit of access logs against the authorized personnel list to identify and correct any discrepancies.

9. Violations and Training

Unauthorized entry into a restricted area is treated as a serious safety and security violation, subject to immediate investigation and disciplinary action up to and including termination for repeated or willful violations. Authorized personnel receive area-specific training, including hazard recognition and emergency procedures, before being granted access, with recertification every 2 years or upon any change to the area's hazard profile.